



**JABATAN PEMBANGUNAN KEMAHIRAN
KEMENTERIAN SUMBER MANUSIA
ARAS 7 & 8 BLOK D4, KOMPLEKS D
PUSAT PENTADBIRAN KERAJAAN PERSEKUTUAN
62530 PUTRAJAYA**

KERTAS PENERANGAN (*INFORMATION SHEET*)

KOD DAN NAMA PROGRAM / <i>PROGRAM'S CODE AND NAME</i>	Z-009-2:2015 CORE ABILITIES	
TAHAP / LEVEL	2 (TWO)	
NO. DAN TAJUK KEBOLEHAN TERAS / <i>CORE ABILITY NO. AND TITLE</i>	CA03 WORK PLACE CULTURE BEHAVIOR	
NO. DAN PENYATAAN KEBOLEHAN / <i>ABILITY NO. AND STATEMENT</i>	03.01 PRACTICED WORK CULTURE 03.02 RESPOND APPROPRIATELY TO UNSUAL SITUATIONS 03.03 DEMONSTRATE INITIATIVE AND FLEXIBILITY	
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TAJUK/TITLE : WORK CULTURE PRACTICES

TUJUAN/PURPOSE :

This Information Sheet is intended to describe on the abilities to understand cultural and ethnic differences and gender sensitivity between team members. The person who is competent in this CA shall be able to apply sensitivity judgement of ethical differences in interactions.

PENERANGAN/INFORMATION :

Most workplaces today employ people from diverse cultural backgrounds. Some workers may have specific cultural needs or requirements which should be taken into account such as dress, religious practices, customs, social values, family obligations and non-verbal behavior.

1. Custom and culture

A custom is anything which lots of people do, and have done for a long time. Usually, the people come from the same country, culture, time or religion.

The meaning of culture is similar to the meaning of custom. A custom is more about practices, while culture is more about ideas or a group of customs. A custom overall is just similar to culture and culture means the way of life of a people.

It is important to cultivate a positive culture right from the beginning because it is difficult to change behaviors and attitudes that have become the norm.



Figure 1.1 : Example of different custom and culture



Figure 1.2 : Example of different culture's attire and gesture

Workplace culture

- 1.1 Every workplace consists of its own culture. Workplace culture tends to evolve over time, although employer can take measures to change it if they deem it necessary.
- 1.2 Workplace culture can be shaped by the employer and the types of policy and procedures they set as well as the types of people they hire. Things such as dress code, job titles, behavioral policies and even the gender or ethnicity of the work force play roles in shaping the culture.
- 1.3 Your company culture reflects the beliefs, values and behaviors of everyone in your workforce. As a result, company culture has a significant effect on the success of a business.
- 1.4 The culture of a workplace can play a significant role in its productivity. For example, if the culture is one where employees are encouraged to help one another, it may foster the development of teamwork. On the other hand, if the culture is one where workers tend to keep to themselves, it may be difficult for a new employee to fit in.
- 1.5 Employees and employers should also consider cultural differences as possible reasons for problem or misunderstandings in the workplace. Treating people unfairly at work because of their cultural differences may be unlawful under equal opportunity laws.
- 1.6 Employers are responsible for their worker's physical and psychological health and well-being and should encourage tolerance and respect for cultural differences in the workplace.

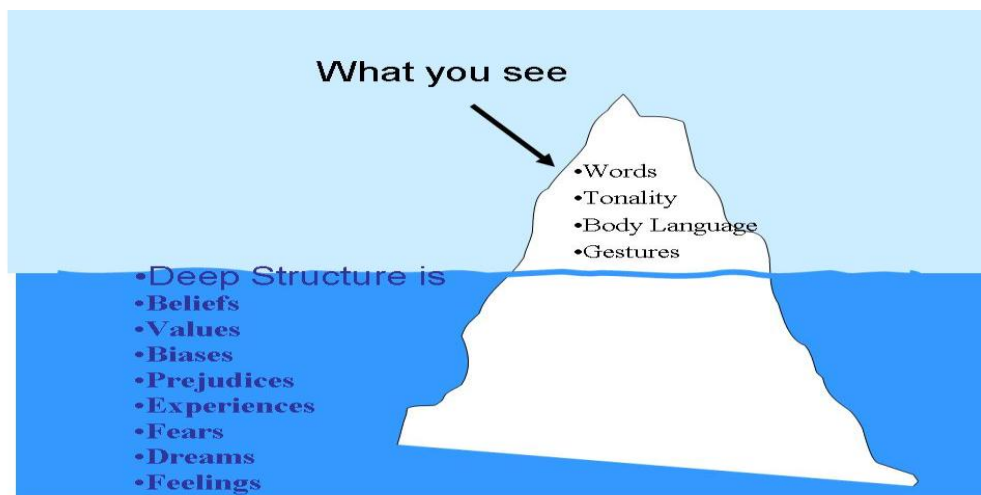


Figure 1.3 : The popular “Iceberg Model” of culture developed by Selfridge and Sokolik, 1975 and W.L. French and C.H. Bell in 1979, identifies a visible

area consisting of behavior or symbols and artifacts of some form and level of values or an invisible level

2. Religion / beliefs



Figure 2.1 : Example of religion places of worship in Malaysia

A religion is an organized collection of beliefs, cultural systems and world views that relate humanity to an order of existence. Many religions have narratives, symbols and sacred histories that aim to explain the meaning of life, the origin of life or the Universe.

From their beliefs about the cosmos and human nature, people may derive morality ethics, religious laws or a preferred lifestyle.

3. Sensitivity issues

Sensitivity issues in the workplace can be both a moral and a legal issue. Insensitivity not only leads to hurt feelings and low morale, the offended employee may bring legal action against the employer. To ensure no sensitivity issues arise in the workplace such as racism, harassment, inappropriate behavior and sexism,

employees should be properly trained and action should be taken in the event of violation.

4. Social interaction skills

Social Interaction Skill



Figure 4.1 : Example of social interaction skills image

Social skills and success in life are both correlated. People have good social interaction skills feel more comfortable to interact with other people. They make better relationships, good friends and achieve their goals easily. The most effective way to build social interaction skills are:-

4.1 Extrovert

Try to develop ability to interact with others by meeting new people, having conversation with them and build strong relations with them.

4.2 Take risks

Risk means expressing your thoughts and feelings and that must support your behavior. Behaviors during interaction with others show your attitude towards them.

4.3 Take feedback

Taking feedback from people with whom you interact is best way to improve your social interaction skills. Other people can give idea about your strength and weakness related to positive and negative side of your personality.

4.4 Interact with socially skilled people

Interacting with people who are good in interpersonal skills helps you immensely. Try to learn mannerism and social skills with them.

4.5 Define your goals

Always set your goal to strengthen your skills which are vital and most important for social interaction skill development.

5. Human resources guidelines



Figure 5.1 : Example of human resources cycle

Human resources are the set of individuals who make up the workforce of an organization, business sector or economy. The professional discipline and business function that oversees an organization's human resources is called human resource management (HRM or simply HR).

The division of a company is focused on activities relating to employees. These activities normally include recruiting and hiring of new employees, orientation and training of current employees, employee benefits and retention.

6. Communication skills



Figure 6.1 : Example of communication skills

- 6.1 The definition of verbal communication is how and what words are used to communicate with individuals. It is the ability to communicate through words with the correct tone and manner. The definition of non-verbal communication is which consists of facial expressions, body language and hand gestures.

Two-way communication is essential when developing a set of excellent interpersonal skills.

- 6.2 The importance of communication skills

So what are the specific communication skills which are most important? To understand this, it may be helpful to understand basic communication patterns which are already occurring at work. Pay attention to what is said when talking to others and pay equal attention to the person's response. Don't ignore non-verbal cues such as yawning, crossed arms and other signs of boredom or frustration. These are signs that communication needs to be enhanced.

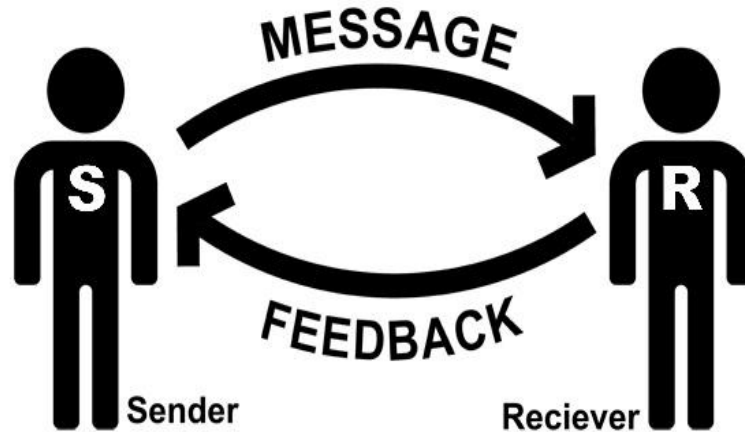


Figure 6.2 : Example of good communication

- 6.3 The importance of communication skills can be seen when good, quality communication occurs that prevents misunderstandings, miscommunication and conflict. It produces productive work and performance which ultimately impacts the company's bottom line.
- 6.4 The importance of communication skills are often listed in the "top four" job skills which predict both employee and employer satisfaction. Poor communication is often a reason that employees quit jobs or look elsewhere to find other opportunities. A vital part of communication is making employees feel understood and valued.



Figure 6.3 : Example of bad communication

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SOALAN / QUESTIONS:

1. What is the different between custom and culture?

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2. How can a company culture effect on the success of the business?

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3. Why do employee need to understand communication skills?

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